LVM3/ONEWEB MISSION

LAUNCHED INTO THE BIG LEAGUE

INDIA'S BIGGEST ROCKET HAS LAUNCHED ITS HEAVIEST PAYLOAD AND ENTERED THE GLOBAL SERVICE MARKET TO FERRY COMMERCIAL SATELLITES INTO SPACE

By **AMARNATH K. MENON**

MISSION FACT FILE

FULL NAME: LVM3-M2/ OneWeb India-1 mission

ROCKET: Launch Vehicle Mark 3 (or LVM-3)

LAUNCH CENTRE: Satish Dhawan Space Centre, Sriharikota, Andhra Pradesh

TIME: 12.07 am, Dec. 23

STATUS: Success

36
Number of satellites put into orbit

5,796
KILOGRAM
Total weight of satellites

19
MINUTES
Time taken by the rocket to reach its designated orbit

75
MINUTES
Time taken to inject and position all satellites in the orbit*

₹1,000
CRORE
Amount OneWeb paid ISRO for launching 72 satellites, 36 of which will be launched in the next mission planned in 2023

** ISRO had to ensure the precise injection of all satellites into a 601-km orbit with the separation sequenced in such a way that there is a minimum 137-metre distance between any two of them*

THE FIRSTS

FIRST commercial launch undertaken by LVM-3

FIRST multiple satellite mission of LVM-3 to low earth orbit (601 km)

FIRST Indian launch with nearly 6,000 kg payload

FIRST OneWeb mission with NSIL*

**UK-based OneWeb plans a 648-satellite internet constellation to provide a global communication network powered from space (this was its 14th launch); NewSpace India Limited (NSIL) is ISRO's commercial arm and comes under the administrative control of Department of Space*

